

Νικοχάρης ὁ κωμικός

Symposium and Satire in the Fragments of Nicochares

eul_aid: fcs

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Κωμωδία Ἀττική](#) [Attic Comedy](#)
Domain: [Κωμωδία](#) [Comedy](#)
Format: [Ἑμμετρος](#) [Verse](#)

Nicochares was an Athenian comic poet active in the late 5th and early 4th centuries BCE. He is considered a transitional figure between the era of Old Comedy, known for its political satire, and the subsequent period of Middle Comedy.

According to ancient sources, he was the son of the comic playwright Philonides and won a victory at the City Dionysia festival, with one victory recorded for the year 388 BCE. Only three titles of his plays survive: **Laconians**, a comedy likely parodying Spartans; **The Centaur**; and **Galateia**, the latter two being mythological burlesques. The plays themselves are lost, and our knowledge comes only from fragments cited by later authors.

His career coincided with significant changes in Athenian comedy, including a reduced role for the chorus and a move away from direct political commentary. Nicochares is a minor but historically important figure. His work exemplifies the broader shift in 4th-century comedy toward generalized humor, parody of stereotypes, and mythological themes. He provides evidence for the continuity and evolution of the comic tradition in Athens following the great age of Aristophanes.

Works (3)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα τῶν Νηρηίδων](#) · [Fragments of the Nereids](#) · 6 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Symptotic Fragments](#) · 16 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα Νικοχάρους Συμποτικά](#) · [Symptotic Fragments of Nicochares](#) · 26 passages